

Proposition

Language emerged as verbal communications long before it was written down.

Mother of all human languages was a spoken language. It emerged in Homo Erectus, if not before.

Spoken Language emerged with single phonemes (called *वर्ण*) .

These single phonemes evolved into multi-phoneme words. Words evolved into *Vibhakties*. They both together evolved into grammar. That evolved and diverged into full fledged language. With People migrating over different geographies, languages diverged further and different languages evolved.

The roots of language evolution **were** forgotten.

But history is not lost.

Original root meanings of single phoneme words can be traced and deciphered from अष्टाध्यायी सूत्रपाठ and धातुपाठ.

I have deciphered these meanings. More work is needed to improve degree of certainty and level of confidence and fine tune meanings.

History of mankind can be understood once we decipher this proto/pre language with high certainty. Because ample literature has been preserved.

So hypothesis is –

Language evolved from Homo Erectus or earlier. Original language had one *वर्ण* words.

Dictionary from this time is preserved in form of माहेश्वर सूत्र. This was teaching material and hence it has survived.

Later, words evolved to have multiple *वर्ण*. Education material from this era had series of सूत्र. These evolved into धातुपाठ सूत्रपाठ of अष्टाध्यायी.

या कदाचिदनावृत्ता केवलं स्वेच्छया॥

If I ask you to prove that the meaning of “word” is word; you can’t.
But if I accept your meaning of “word” to be a word, we can communicate about the whole world.

While reading this work, some may get tempted to ask me to prove what I am narrating. I can’t.

Meanings can’t be proven.

In maths, what is number can’t be proven. In physics, the meaning of mass and space-time.

Similarly, I can’t prove what is the meaning of “व”. I try to share what I have seen.

May you know वद.

And some things that should not have been forgotten were lost.
History became legend, legend became myth, and for twelve and a half thousand years, the meaning passed out of all knowledge. Until, when chance came, it ensnared another bearer.
(with due credit to LOTR)

This is page 0. Its contents are difficult to comprehend or convey unless you are on the same page.
That is the nature of 0.
Next is page 1. There start meanings that can be explained and understood, albeit with effort.
That is the nature of 1 and thereafter. 0 is different.

This is a work in progress as of Jan 2025. Inputs are welcome on keyur1277@gmail.com
This page is added for my creative expression. You may ignore this.

Origins of Language – Introduction

Language emerged as verbal communication before it was written down.

The first challenge people faced while making computers understand human speech was **phoneme categorization**. When different people speak, let us say, व, the sound wave for each instance is distinct. Yet humans identify all those various forms of sound waves into one phoneme व. This is called **phoneme categorization**. We can assume that this would have been the first step in the natural evolution of language.

In some distant past evolution bestowed the brains of some species with this ability to categorize similar sounds as a class. This enabled objective communication using sound.

The evolution of language started from this point on. The evolution of language is THE most important story in human history. Civilization and all the advantages of being Human we enjoy arose from language.

Because this history is important, our predecessors made extraordinary efforts to preserve this history. I can understand a small portion of what they have preserved. A great deal of work is yet needed. Despite the incomplete nature of the work, I am trying to explain what I have stumbled upon so that you may enhance and expand.

Although different persons speak व differently, all those distinct sounds of व can be interpreted as belonging to one class व. Once such identification of actually different sounds that can be perceived to be the same evolves in brain circuits, objective communication between two brains using a medium of sound becomes possible.

Brains (of many animals, including primates, apes, and consequently humans) are capable of classifying sounds into distinct classes (वर्ण). This enables members of the species to communicate objectively (with each other) using sounds.

This happens because there are distinct regions of the brain that are associated with hearing and producing a given वर्ण. The same neural circuits get fired up when sounds of the same वर्ण are listened to or pronounced. All sounds that do not have such distinct neural circuits, can be called अवर्ण¹. The sounds of most musical instruments are अवर्ण. As my objective is language here, we will not pursue अवर्ण discussion.

Regions of the brain – neural circuits – that are associated with each वर्ण are also connected to other parts of the brain. Let us denote neural circuitry related to व as व. So, I will write a Dev-Nagari वर्ण with an underline to indicate neural circuitry that is associated with the sound

¹ The word अवर्ण is derived from नञ्+वर्ण. As we will see later, नञ् means pull (न) + surface (ञ). Something like pull surface from someone/something. Hence it means negation. The word नञ् emerged in a species that was able to produce nasal sounds distinctly. At some point in evolution new species of Homo, with change in anatomy of nose, lost ability to distinctly pronounce some of म-कार. (There are five म-कार – जमङणन.) नञ् got converted to अ/अन in this species for phonetic reasons. This change was documented, lest we forget the original meaning, in Ashtadhyayi in [6.3.73](#).

and speech of that વર્ણ. વ્ર gets triggered when વ is spoken or heard. Because વ્ર is connected to other parts of the brain; વ્ર also gets triggered by other events based on the connection વ્ર happens to have with the rest of the brain. So, usage of વર્ણ વ tends to coincide more with other “events” that cause activation of વ્ર due to the neural circuitry of that “event” having the ability to trigger (or get triggered by) વ્ર. We will call such “event” ં of વ and write it as ં(વ). (Here I am using ં as a short form for અર્થ. For clarification - it has nothing to do with નન્ in this context.) ં(વ) is what transformers related to વ are trying to mimic in language models.

Let us assume that the blowing of wind is ં(વ).

So, when the wind blew, or when the wind was blown by moving air out of lips, or when someone fanned the fire, or when someone moved muscles that were moved to blow wind...and all those “events” that activated neural circuitry entangled with ં(વ), વ્ર also got activated and brain dimly perceived² as if it has heard/spoken વ. On the other hand, when someone did speak વ, brain experienced – with all their senses, dimly, as if the wind was blowing, and all other “events” associated with વ્ર. Because વ્ર triggered ં(વ) in the brain, thus, *Meaning* arose from connections in the neural structure of the brain. This made sound-based communication (language) possible. Another being³ could understand language without learning the meaning of વર્ણ beforehand. Because meanings reside(d) inside the brain in form of neural structures that was common across species, વર્ણ-based communications – use of language – was/became possible without having to learn meanings of વર્ણ in advance.

In this sense, the meaning of વ is built into the brain of species. Earliest Homo/Ape/Primate species that were at the cusp of language evolution, વ્ર only had biologically occurring connections⁴.

In this era, people felt very distinctly that sound વ itself had meaning and that meaning was as tangible and sense-able as the blowing of the wind. Something akin to what “**Prey drive**” does in the visual cortex. There is no need to teach “Prey Drive”. It is built in the nature of the animal itself. In this sense, earliest orators felt that the meaning of વ (meaning of all વર્ણ for that matter) is eternal, omnipresent, and arose from the fabric of reality itself.

In this sense, they were right when they believed that, વર્ણ/sound (and their meanings) are eternal. Each વર્ણ has a meaning that is શાશ્વત and સનાતન. They rightly believed that spoken words and their meanings are not “created” by anyone. વર્ણ sounds and their meanings are part of eternal existence like the Sun and Moon are (or matter and energy for physicists). Nobody created them. They are અ-પૌરુષેય. Everyone was intuitively able to understand the

² Gujarati word અણસાર is nearest description of what I am referring to as “perceive” here.

³ This was pre homo sapience so another “being” in stead of another “person” is appropriate word.

⁴ Connections arising out of use (and extreme overuse) of language had not happened yet. In this sense, their minds were not polluted by language.

meanings of वर्ण. It must have been a miracle that when these वर्ण sounds were made, others were able to understand them intuitively⁵. Some द्रष्टा were able to identify these sounds because sounds and meanings chose to show their beauty to them.

Initially, this proto-language consisted of one वर्ण words. The entire dictionary of all languages consisted of 47¹ वर्ण in total. Each वर्ण meant whatever its respective brain circuitry was connected to. What each वर्ण meant can't be explained precisely in words, the way music can't be expressed in words. They were in a territory between music and language proper. For example, घ meant hunt. It was a weapon, an order to hunt, a call to action, a description of the situation, emotions felt during hunting, a sign to coordinate the hunt, and all other things connected with घ – all in one syllable. Similarly, every वर्ण was a word, sentence, process, emotion, etc. all at once. It indicated everything that was linked to the neural circuit - अर्थ of that वर्ण.

This technology of communication through speech exploded the knowledge that species had. Experiences and learnings of elders could be taught to kids by talking, without real experience, exposure to risk, or consuming time. Words (वर्ण) simulated the experience in the brain of a kid as if he experienced it in real life. Species transmitted knowledge through generations and compounded knowledge. Knowledge compounding over generations made the species superior to those who could not do so.

Over some time, It so happened that multiple वर्ण were used repeatedly in the same sequences. For example, नञ् was used together as a single action. Theoretically, there are 2916 possible situations where नञ् is an appropriate meaningful sentence⁶. But it was used, more often than not, referring to pulling net (surface). So, over a period of time, नञ् also came to carry the meaning of “pull surface”, besides न and ञ् having their own separate meanings. This secondary meaning was not intuitive and had to be taught. A child can be taught all about ञ् even if the kid has not seen a surface/net ever. Because when he would see a surface/net, it (net) would naturally connect to “ञ्” in the brain. That is not so for “नञ्”. Derived words – artificial words - had to be taught before they could be understood. These derived words were arising out of external physical reality and not brain circuitry. Hence, they had to be learned.

⁵ Can we experience such a thing? Not with spoken language anymore because we have overused language circuits in brain. But we can have same experience with अवर्ण sounds. Listen to any happy or sad music and you will experience meaning intuitively. The example I like is a piece called “Crazy Frog”. The “meaning” of that sound can be felt without learning it. Because it is not a वर्ण (class), meaning is not objectively same for two persons. But it is somewhat similar for all. Feeling that it gives is शाश्वत, सनातन and अपौरुषेय. It is built-into the listener and sound itself. This is what the words of वर्ण being सनातन and अपौरुषेय meant - Meaning was built in.

⁶ Because each letter is word, actually more than a word, I am calling two letters as sentence here. $2916 = 9 \times 9 \times 6 \times 6 = 9$ phonetic variations of न with a स्वर (उदत्त, अनुदत्त, स्वरित x ह्रस्व दीर्घ प्लुत) and ञ् each having possible 9 different meaning * 6 interpretations (5 विभक्ति+1 verb) for each.

We may call this transition from intuitive meaning to learned meaning, as “संज्ञा⁷ revolution” in language. Words were made labels, i.e. indirect pointers to neural circuits instead of direct entanglement with neural regions/circuits.

Along with evolution of संज्ञा words; वर्ण evolved into two distinct subsets - स्वर (self-flowing) and व्यञ्जन (special ones⁸). व्यञ्जन are the material of the process (विधि / क्रिया) and स्वर gave directions/instructions. स्वर were proto-विभक्ति. Artificial words made from multiple वर्ण having derived/composite meanings were called “धातु⁹”. Typical धातु (process) had two or more वर्ण. व्यञ्जन were added to indicate materials. स्वर were added to denote material or proto-विभक्ति¹⁰. Proto-विभक्ति conveyed this - from X (संप्रदान), to Y (अपादान) at Z (अधिकरण). म्-कार were part of most of धातु. Five म्-कार meant - inside(म्), surface(ञ्), outside(ङ्), pull (न) and push(ण).

The language/grammar had not yet evolved to clearly distinguish between verb, subject, object, etc¹¹, past present or future tenses¹². Lot of other grammar stuff had not evolved yet. All धातु communicated was something like - “(This is) how to do (something)”

With this, the entire communication of species became action क्रिया/विधि oriented. Nearly all धातु-based communications necessarily became action-centric. And धातु based communication became dominant. Communication without a verb became a rarity. “Being” was labelled as an activity¹³. Classified as भाव वाचक later on but a धातु. We will refer to this event as “डुकृञ्¹⁴ revolution in language”. This revolution made verb and verbal synonyms. Before this verbal was not always verb-centric¹⁵. It had a profound impact on human existence that was to follow. The mind running on Language OS got infected by the “itch-to-do” virus. It is very likely that डुकृञ् revolution was a mind/brain event triggered by language and not a physiological/anatomical evolution event triggered by a genetic mutation.

⁷ Why संज्ञा? Because संज्ञा means label. Literally it means gather स-inside म्-wide ज-surface ञ् upto here आ. ज (wide ज-surface ञ्) has composite meaning of “spread/expand”. So संज्ञा literally meant - gathered inside spread upto here.

⁸ It literally means “spoken to be held at surface spread by pulling”, underlined aspects interchangeable across all वर्ण of the word व्यञ्जन. The name indicates it was something to be acted on.

⁹ धातु means something that carries

¹⁰ संप्रदान, अपादान, आधीकरण, action(क्रियापद), doer (कर्ता), desire and instrument/tool.

¹¹ 3.1.85 अष्टाध्यायी सूत्रपाठ

¹² 3.4.6 अष्टाध्यायी सूत्रपाठ

¹³ Epistemologically, this is a mistake. If being can be perceived as a non-क्रिया creator is not needed. Whole Creator God nonsense happened because of this error.

¹⁴ Bear with me on why such a strange name.

¹⁵ In my opinion, ability to be and remain happy (and perhaps unhappy) goes substantially down once “verb” (action/need for and call for action) takes the driver seat in one’s mind. All search for peace of mind, मोक्ष, निर्वाण, तुरीय are search to turn off this action centricity and go to “निः/निस् वाणी” state.

We only have a list of धातु from this era. Grammar/treaties on how these धातु are formed are lost. Language at the end of this period is pre-Vaidic Sanskrit. The only literature from this era that we have access to is the earliest parts of वेद and parts of वेदांग. Of these, वेद are saved in their original form. वेदांग have interpolations added to work as translators between later date language and language of वेद. We do not understand the language of वर्ण to धातु transition period clearly. We should have a better understanding of this literature once we decipher the meanings of वर्ण.

A few thousand, or tens of thousands, years after वर्ण to धातु expansion; पद were made from धातु mimicking the way धातु were made from वर्ण. But with more varieties and complexities – षष्टि विभक्ति was added, a whole new world of प्रत्यय was invented, लिंग (gender), ल-कार (tense and mood), वचन (number), etc. were introduced. With this second round, infinite words could be made from धातु. We have grammar proper for this era. In this era, the language is somewhere between Vaidik Sanskrit and Classical Sanskrit. We understand language/s from this point on without the need to decipher meaning of वर्ण. By this time, almost all words had become संज्ञा words. Memory that all words are derived words is preserved in निरुक्त and निघंटु. We clearly understand the rules for making पद from धातु. We have access to अष्टाध्यायी giving these rules. If languages can be compared to species, from this point onwards, species of language is similar to of modern day daughters of Sanskrit - Gujarati, Hindi, Marathi, Telugu, Kannada, Tamil and other Indian languages, Persian, Russian, Latin, Greek, English and many others. Language before this point is the same genus but a different species, so to speak.

Let us go back to the period when धातु were formed from वर्ण.

The ability to understand the meaning of वर्ण intuitively was slowly getting lost with the overuse of language changing neural connections. In this era, neural connections were not only naturally occurring connections, but brains also had a large portion of acquired/learned/taught connections. With every new generation, वृ in new generations was different from वृ in earlier generations. Biologically occurring neural connections were increasingly overshadowed by learned/acquired neural connections. Also, with the evolutionary change in species, the association between वर्ण and अ(वर्ण) was slowly changing along with changes in anatomy resulting in changes in the brain structure itself.

As a result, instead of being naturally understandable, meanings of sounds had to be taught/learned. Even when learned, they became abstraction instead of a sense-able/feel-able reality.

There was awareness about the loss of the ability to intuitively understand language. The language was THE most advanced technology in society. So, efforts were made to preserve this knowledge and technology. The system was bootstrapped and continuing it was not a challenge because language can be taught once enough number of persons are there to learn from. Once bootstrapped, the system can self-sustain. Our ancestors did not know that. They were worried about the loss of “speech technology” and allocated huge resources to preserve

this knowledge/technology of speech. That is how we have literature preserved from this era. In the absence of writing of any sort, all these would have been lost otherwise.

Today, if the human species starts losing¹⁶ its ability to understand maths and consequently sciences, efforts would be made to preserve maths and technologies. The whole effort was very similar to that. Because this literature is preserved, and in most cases EXACTLY as it was originally spoken¹⁷, we can peep back in time and listen to them. We can understand them almost completely if we decipher the meanings of every वर्ण.

The process of preserving and teaching had started immediately after वर्ण based communication started. It must have been taught by simultaneous speaking वर्ण and acting/enacting meanings. The phonetic part preserved from this era is what we may call lexicon, dictionary, or वर्ण-माला. Because all words consist of only one वर्ण, the alphabet itself is a dictionary. Because only वर्ण were there, they could not be explained in other वर्ण/words. It is just a list of words/वर्ण and no explanation of their meanings. There were no words to express meanings in. One such list is preserved as माहेश्वर सूत्र inside अष्टाध्यायी.

A few tens of thousands of years¹⁸ after माहेश्वर सूत्र, धातु were added to the lexicon. That is preserved as धातु पाठ part of अष्टाध्यायी.

Original single letter dictionary, that is preserved and accessible today, is माहेश्वर सूत्र. List of धातु are available in धातु पाठ of अष्टाध्यायी. Because this list of धातु is gathered over a long period, it contains धातु from the earliest period up to the end of the bronze age¹⁹.

At present, the original self-evident meaning of वर्ण of माहेश्वर सूत्र is lost. We need to decipher set of meanings of all 47 वर्ण to understand ancient most language.

¹⁶ Inability to distinctly pronounce all म्-कार was something akin to anatomically loosing ability to understand concept of “equal.” Knowledge of maths would become impossible to transmit to new generations if newborn babies no longer understood what *equal* means. That is the fear Erectus would have had when new babies started popping out with Sapience noses, i.e. with severe म्-कार deficiency. “If they can’t differentiate in ज् (surface) and झ् (periphery/outside), how would they survive?”

¹⁷ There are वर्ण we Sapience are incapable of pronouncing correctly. But we have preserved them by clinging to subtle differences. Besides म्-कार, ऋ has nothing to do with र and लृ has nothing to do with ल. But we are clinging to old memory of ऋ and लृ when they used to be स्वर. I hypothesize that inability to use ऋ and लृ in communication is the root reason humans kill each other far more than any other species. That discussion is beyond present purpose.

¹⁸ or a few hundred of thousand years, who knows? who can know? Those who created language know.

Maybe, they know, maybe they don’t. वेद यदि वा न वेद.

¹⁹ Why the bronze age? Because what we have access to are libraries that were extant at the time of the collapse of the Sarasvati civilization. it is mentioned there that वेद were maintained on “as is” basis, without change, since time immemorial even at that time. Other libraries – वेदांग – were maintained with updates, adding new words and meanings prevailing at the current time, so that they can work as a translator between the prevailing language लोक भाषा and language of वेद. Drying up of Sarasvati is around (and most like a reason for) the Bronze Age Collapse. So, that is cut off for updating वेदांग. अष्टाध्यायी is part of वेदांग.

What I plan to do

Shri Arvnid Ghosh²⁰ (Maharshi Arvind) has tried to decipher the meanings of each वर्ण by meditating on वर्ण. His work is useful as he also believes that वर्ण has intrinsic meaning. For ordinary persons not accustomed to finding meaning from meditations, his approach is not accessible.

Being another ordinary person, I am taking a different route and trying to decipher/deduce वर्ण meanings from surviving meanings/descendant words. Something like finding a vector pointed by all subsequent derived words using the same वर्ण. If I keep my starting set of words as ancient as I can, it will increase the probability of finding the direction from which the original meaning of वर्ण came. So first step is to decode meanings of वर्ण using अष्टाध्यायी धातु पाठ, while restricting myself to two व्यंजन धातु²¹.

This approach is viable because, unlike its daughters, Sanskrit does not have “labeled” meanings – not even for words made after संज्ञा revolution. This is so because all daughters of Sanskrit emerged AFTER संज्ञा revolution and were always based on meanings that had to be learned. Sanskrit always creates words. To explain it further - In English you can't decipher the meaning of christ from C-H-R-I-S-T. In Sanskrit वासुदेवसुतंदेवम् can be derived from वसु-देव-सूत-देव. Because this logic also applies further down, the meaning of वसु would have been derived from व्-अ-स्-उ. With the meaning of व्-अ-स्-उ, rooted in brain circuits of species where from language emerged, these being primordial वर्ण.

Because the meaning of धातु emerges from the meaning of constituent वर्ण, the meaning of वर्ण can be deciphered from धातु containing that वर्ण. “Meaning” has to be taken as a very broad term here referring to primitive brain circuitry and not “meaning” in the modern meaning of the word.

Why do we believe “वसु” is not a starting point and has a meaning of its own without a derived meaning? Because it has been documented to be so, by यास्क and others, that every पद-word²² is derived word. Also because Sanskrit grammar, अष्टाध्यायी, is mainly about how to make words from धातु and not so much about how to construct sentences. In Sanskrit, all words carry their meaning themselves and not depend on remaining of sentence to acquire their meaning. This is why the sequence in which words form a sentence is less important. A sentence can acquire meaning from words. But the word does not acquire meaning from

²⁰ And many other before him.

²¹ Not because two व्यंजन धातु are likely to be old, but because my ability to deal with complexity that arises with three व्यंजन is non-existent. नञ् has 2916 possible meanings if न and ञ् meanings are known. Imagine the difficulty of deciphering ञ् if I have to explore all possibilities arising out of त्रिष्विदा. Also, most of धातु are two व्यंजन. Corpus is less and complexity is more if I attempt beyond two व्यंजन.

²² Using the word “word” because English has the same word for all three - धातु, पद, शब्द

sentences. So, it is reasonable to believe that धातु also carried their “own” meanings and were not a label.

So, how do we decode the original meanings of वर्ण... something that, like music, can't be described in words in the first place?

Way forward

The broad framework (of what I am doing to decipher वर्ण meanings is described here. अष्टाध्यायी gives keys to unlock the distant past. It has the ancient list of धातु wherefrom we have to start our journey backward in time. It also gives list of rules, सूत्र, that are applied on धातु, to make new words.

Once upon a time, धातु represented work/action/process in the physical world. Because the physical world followed certain limitations, words expressing that reality followed certain patterns instead of being random वर्ण combinations. Because धातु followed these patterns, पद/शब्द made from धातु also exhibited secondary patterns and are not random. अष्टाध्यायी narrated the rules of how words are formed. These rules represent some physical and phonetic realities expressed in sounds/वर्ण. Meanings of words at all levels, वर्ण, धातु and पद/शब्द; have arisen from physical reality and described that physical reality.

For example, If there is a rule that means “while using a stone chisel, keep sharp end inside, hold from outside²³”, people not aware of this rule also followed this rule in the real world. And when words (descriptions) emerge from that process/act in the physical world, such words follow this rule. अष्टाध्यायी is this collection of such rules and not arbitrary dictate about words. The first temptation is to apply these rules backward to धातु and derive the meaning of constituent वर्ण. This works at times, but not always.

Because that approach does not always work; We can make a hypothesis about the meaning of वर्ण and check if it leads to the known meanings of धातु made of that वर्ण. If न meant X and ञ् meant Y does नञ् mean something related to X and Y in some way? If it does, X and Y have some validation. If a great deal of धातु validates meaning to be X and Y, we need to check if the rules of अष्टाध्यायी for नञ्, न, and ञ् fit in the meaning of X and Y. If they also fit in, we are nearly certain that X and Y are correct respective meanings.

We can start with some meaning as a starting point and run through all धातु and सूत्र. We need to calibrate the meaning of वर्ण, अ(वर्ण), at comparison with each धातु and every सूत्र. With every iteration, अ(वर्ण) will slowly lead towards original meanings. When we decode one वर्ण, the probability of getting the correct meaning of all remaining वर्ण increases.

Iterations will lead to a state where अ(वर्ण) will stop changing with iterations and will “fit” in the multidimensional jigsaw puzzle of धातुपाठ and सूत्रपाठ. At this stage, we would have understood the meanings of वर्ण, with reasonable certainty.

How do we arrive at the first set of meanings to start iterations?

²³ 3.1.14 कष्टाय क्रमणे क्यङ्. Meaning – “Into कष्ट at क्रमण gets क्यङ्”. Literally meaning - into [stone pointed tool =chisel] at [hand held blood(र) inside push] [hold stone outside /periphery]. To put it in English, while (य) holding (ष) (क)pointed stone, in (ट) bowl/tool, if you (ण) push (क)stone (म्) inside you will get (र)blood; hence (य)hold (क)stone form (ङ्)outside.

Let us take the example of म्, we can list two व्यंजन words of म् from a dictionary (of Sanskrit and its daughters) and check their known meanings. कम, माखी, खम, गम, मग, माघ, मघ, छम, मछ, जम, तं, मत, थम, मथ, मद, दम, मध, धम, नम,मन...etc. This may lead us to believe that म् means “inside”. This becomes the starting point.

Some वर्ण may have a different meaning for different stages of evolution/development. For example, ग meant living animals other than prey and predator. After the domestication of animals. it acquired the meaning of “domestic animals” and consequently transport (गति).

At times, we may have to reinterpret the words given in पाठ to describe the meaning of धातु. If the meaning of some धातु is said to be गतौ, we need to check if the meaning of धातु coincides with the meaning of गतौ reinterpreted using meaning/ अ(वर्ण) of ग त and औ.

By doing this decoding exercise, we can understand the meaning of वर्ण and धातु at different stages of development. We can also figure out original processes/actions that gave meaning to धातु and we can also speculate in which period this धातु would have been added to vocabulary.

After all वर्ण are understood through this process, we can make grammar/rules for वर्ण to धातु evolution. And then....we can attempt to re-interpret ancient most parts of वेद.

My present understanding of the meanings/ अ(वर्ण) is given on the next page. This is yet a work in progress and meanings can change while the work is under progress. For अ(वर्ण) to be finalized, entire धातु पाठ meanings and all सूत्रपाठ given in अष्टाध्यायी should logically fit with अ(वर्ण). I am at a stage where I am convinced that वर्ण had some original root meanings, so many things have fit-in so far that it can't be accidental/random. At the same time, I have not understood meanings with certainty and accuracy, not yet. I am somewhere near, but not at the destination. I am on my way to get there once iteration process is over.

That process, I think, will take the next five to ten years. I will publish the complete work after that.

In the event of my death before publication, I don't want this work to be lost.

I am sharing this early and convincing enough (to me) but incomplete work.

So that someone can take this knowledge forward in that event.

- Keyur Joshi (9925031711)

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माहेश्वर सूत्र/ शिव सूत्र

अइउण् ।

ऋल्क् ।

एओङ् ।

ऐऔच् ।

हयवरट् ।

लण् ।

जमडणनम् ।

झभञ् ।

घढधष् ।

जबगडदश् ।

खफछठथचटतव् ।

कपय् ।

शषसर् ।

हल् ।

Interpretation

अइउ	अ Here. आ up to here. As proto विभक्ति अ represents something that got lost in डुकृञ् revolution. Something akin to exists, word है of Hindi. इ: inward, below, desire, object. As proto विभक्ति it indicates “Desire” विभक्ति. In later period, in प्रत्यय era, Desire विभक्ति morphs into “Object” विभक्ति. उ: up/above may mean gone/lost. It means outward also. As proto विभक्ति it indicates what would be considered तृतीय विभक्ति and क्रिया पद. अइउण् = here inward outward are about push
ऋल्	ऋ-गर्जना of superiority/Victory ल्-whimper of inferiority/surrender pre-homo sapiens sounds – remnant use existed in Vedic times, only memory exists in present time and ऋ is almost universally pronounced as ह्र due to our inability to pronounce ऋ Similarly लृ is pronounced as लृ.

	These are स्वर. So It should be possible to add them to व्यञ्जन. It should be and needs to be pronounced without the tongue (front/back) touching any part of the mouth. You hold your tongue (with fingers) and try to speak ऋ and then ॠ. You will get something similar to the original/intended स्वर वर्ण उच्चार. ऋ means superior in hierarchy ॠ means inferior in hierarchy. ऋलृक् = higher and lower superiority is about क् hand/ hand held stone
एओ	ए Point of connection – receive ओ Point of separation – from एओइ = receiving and separation (संप्रदान अपादान) are about periphery इ
ऐऔ	ऐ-mix, connect. evolved into षष्टि औ- at आधीकरण ऐऔच् mix/connect and आधीकरण are about च् (repeation/walk)
हयवर	ह (कण्ठ्य-from throat) Dry grass (horripilation), here, य Hold/join/connect/yoke/proper- योग्य)/mix, thought(?)/ hold in prehensile sense व swing on vine/branch/rope, air/ wind/ Blow/ mouth/ fan/ make/ speak/ grow/speech/language/ ability of language to “own”/control/ speaker and hence a person र blood of prey, sharp (that causes blood). Water-hydration, fluid, Fire, fear+joy, giving protection, sound (of flow), work/existence/engaged/engrossed/state of “flow” हयवरट् = dry grass, hold/join, व, liquid/blood are about ट् bowl/concave/convex.
ल	Wet soil, level/ take/ soften/remove/peel Soft parts of prey – fat, meat Mark/identify/soil/smear लण् = wet soil is about shovel
जमडणन	ज: skin/surface (शुक्र) म: Inside ड=outside/Periphery ण = Push. Shovel stick with a curve/point at end, away but reachable / tool with which something is pushed/pulled . to pull something near/push away. Subsequently, as प्रत्यय doer/achiever/ instrument to do. न = Pull. lower, on ground/rope with noose/ to pull/ instrument

	ण is push shovel in ground and न is to pull soil out. त्र म and ड can be interchanged for pronunciation convenience. न and ण can be interchanged for pronunciation convenience. जमडणनम् = surface, inside outside, push pull are about inside.
झभ	झ: vibrating/wavering)/ unsteady (not jumping) भ: boat/stand/ steady/ not contained/ not sitting झभञ् = vibrating and steady are about surface
घढध	घ: game animal (kill/ hunted/ wild) शिकार/ weapon like a hammer ढ: fallen prey (later on acts that is done on carcass of prey)/ useless portion of prey ध carry the carcass of prey (carry/ hold (in carry/bear sense) / bear originally a prey/hunted but later on generalized for anything carried/born/held) act to carry like this Carry out spoken instructions. घढधष् = hunt, useless and useful portions of hunt are about pointed
जबगडद	ज: widen/ open up (eat/give birth/jump))/ spread/declare ब contained/bounded/seated ग domesticated (alive/going/domesticated as opposed to घ- game/prey/killed (normally ग and घ should not form a word) ड:- (fear/frightening/ predator); pejorative/ द roll an object as opposed to carrying it (ध)/ give/ infuse / share/hit/throw – not द is ध जबगडदश् =
खफछठथचटत	ख= not क = hollow = to hollow, dig फ = not प = waterless/ leg-less / limb less/. Swelling- sudden increase, spontaneous छ = not च = not walking , not repeating, drill, moving at one place only ठ= depression/low ground = not raised place/ platform= fall थ = = raised place, not त; mount/mound²⁴ च = walk/repeat/more so/ knot/ THINK? ट= shape of bowl/bucket as in Persian wheel, small/less, specific that; different/ small tool like bowl, chisel त = that, you= त(that/there) ; generalize that; Tumbi/sphere खफछठथचटतव् =
कप	क hand held hard thing (stone/tool), what, indicating question/unknown

²⁴ As a side note, English word mound itself comes from Sanskrit मण meaning inside push.

	प= जटा – hair locks, rope, limb, not hard thing held by limb)/ rope/auxiliary limb, seedling/sprout कप emerged when feet too were prehensile. कपय् = hand and leg/limb/rope are about prehensile hold.
शषस	श = long/ wooden staff/ javelin/swollen-elongate/ stiff/ erect ष = pointed/needle-point/ thorn/ droplet/डोलेलियो स= gathered, parallel, equal line straight line/needle शषसर् =
ह	ह (उर-chest) – hard/ dry clay/ Exists/indeed/ bone While sharpening a stone tool with another, the one with which sharpening is done is ह and the one which is chipped away is ल. I suspect that the ह in ऋ and ल in लृ is where from this usage comes. There were two different ह. Repetition is not error or innovation in my opinion. Which ह is used needs to be deciphered based on the context as both ह have merged into one. Like ऋलृ either this or previous ह is lost and we are no longer able to pronounce this ह distinct enough to be useful in speech. This loss had happened in so distant past that unlike ऋ and लृ, the memory of different ह is not preserved. Only usage difference is preserved between the two types of ह. हल् =

My take on the meanings of स्वर

usage	indicates	indicates	in itself	स्वर
क्रियापद	क्रिया /भाव	Verb	outward/up	उ/ऊ
प्रथम	कर्ता /??	Something beyond कृ before डुकृन् revolution. Morphed into "Subject"	here/ till	अ / आ
द्वितीय	कर्म /इप्सितमं	Desire/object. Originally meant "desire" later morphed into "Object"	inward/low	इ / ई
तृतीय	करण / हेतु	Instrument/object		
चतुर्थी	सं-प्रदान	pt of connection – new connection य		ए

पंचमी	अप- आदान	pt of separation – loosening connection य		ओ
सप्तमी	अधी- करण	para instrument		औ
षष्टि	संबंध	Continuous connection य		ऐ /य
अष्टमी	सम्बोधन			

In pre-dhatu stage, क्रियापद, कर्ता, कर्म, करण are interchangeable. षष्टि does not exist and संप्रदान is used as षष्टि. षष्टि later means continued connection. संप्रदान means receiving – new connection happening. सम्बोधन loses its day to day use post डुकृत् revolution.

ⁱ पाणिनी शिक्षा say there were 64 or 63 letters. I believe originally there were 47. Later it expanded to 64 many thousand years later. I believe that because Maheshwar sutra has 47 elements.